Persist Week of March 30, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at **support@functional-bodybuilding.com**

We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.
This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x
- Monday, March 30th, 2026
- Tuesday, March 31st, 2026
- Wednesday, April 1st, 2026
- Thursday, April 2nd, 2026
- Friday, April 3rd, 2026
- Saturday, April 4th, 2026
- Sunday, April 5th, 2026

Pump Lift 4x
- Monday, March 30th, 2026
- Tuesday, March 31st, 2026
- Wednesday, April 1st, 2026
- Thursday, April 2nd, 2026
- Friday, April 3rd, 2026
- Saturday, April 4th, 2026
- Sunday, April 5th, 2026

Pump Lift 3x
- Monday, March, 30th, 2026
- Tuesday, March, 31st, 2026
- Wednesday, April, 1st, 2026
- Thursday, April, 2nd, 2026
- Friday, April, 3rd, 2026
- Saturday, April, 4th, 2026

- Sunday, April 5th, 2026
- Pump Condition 5x
  - Monday, March 30th, 2026
  - Tuesday, March 31st, 2026
  - Wednesday, April 1st, 2026
  - Thursday, April 2nd, 2026
  - Friday, April 3rd, 2026
  - Saturday, April 4th, 2026
  - Sunday, April 5th, 2026
- Pump Condition 4x
  - Monday, March 30th, 2026
  - Tuesday, March 31st, 2026
  - Wednesday, April 1st, 2026
  - Thursday, April 2nd, 2026
  - Friday, April 3rd, 2026
  - Saturday, April 4th, 2026
  - Sunday, April 5th, 2026
- Pump Condition 3x
  - Monday, March 30th, 2026
  - Tuesday, March 31st, 2026
  - Wednesday, April 1st, 2026
  - Thursday, April 2nd, 2026
  - Friday, April 3rd, 2026
  - Saturday, April 4th, 2026
  - Sunday, April 5th, 2026
- Perform
  - Monday, March 30th, 2026
  - Tuesday, March 31st, 2026
  - Wednesday, April 1st, 2026
  - Thursday, April 2nd, 2026
  - Friday, April 3rd, 2026
  - Saturday, April 4th, 2026
  - Sunday, April 5th, 2026
- Minimalist
  - Monday, March 30th, 2026
  - Tuesday, March 31st, 2026
  - Wednesday, April 1st, 2026

Thursday, April 2nd, 2026
Friday, April 3rd, 2026
Saturday, April 4th, 2026
Sunday, April 5th, 2026

Pump Lift 5x

Monday, March 30th, 2026

Week 2 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Note
- Single Leg DB RDL Technique
During the single-leg DB RDL, let your back foot point toward the ground rather than opening out to the side. This helps your pelvis rotate toward the front leg and allows for a smoother, more natural hinge at the hip. You can reinforce this by gently turning your “zipper line” slightly toward the stance leg as you lower the weight. Both cues improve hip mechanics and help you feel the work where we want it most — the glutes of the working leg rather than the low back. Focus on control and balance first, then load.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Split Squat Isometric; 20-30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 minutes)
Cyclist Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

3 sets; rest 60sec between sides
Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for an RPE of 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remaining two sets.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Leg Behind Plate Loaded Pistol; 6-8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Plate Loaded Banded Spanish Squat; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
DB Side Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 30 sec
Weighted Anchored Sit Up; 10-15 reps
rest 60 sec and back to 1.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, March 31st, 2026

Week 2 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:
DB Bench Press Progression
This training block uses three different dumbbell bench press variations, each providing a slightly different stimulus. The traditional DB bench press serves as the baseline. The alternating DB bench press increases time under tension since one arm stabilizes while the other performs the rep. The low incline DB bench press adds a longer range of motion and challenges the pecs from a slightly

different angle. Each variation brings its own benefit, and rotating through all three helps develop a more balanced and resilient shoulder complex for horizontal pressing.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Banded Shoulder External Rotation; 10-15 reps/side
PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Push Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Alternating DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Deficit Pushup; 8-10 @ 31X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 8-10 @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets

Hollow Body DB Floor Press; 10-12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 15 sec
Band or Cable Chest Fly; 12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Wednesday, April 1st, 2026

Week 2 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Pulldown/Pull Up Descending Rep Scheme
The descending rep scheme (12, 10, 8), paired with increasing RPE, is designed to let you add load to each set. This is straightforward with the pulldown—simply increase the weight as the reps decrease. Pull Ups can be a bit different. Because they're highly fatiguing, you may keep the same level of assistance across all sets and still reach the target RPE. Each set builds fatigue in the back and lats, making the next set feel significantly harder even without changing the assistance. Focus on matching the effort, not forcing the progression.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Supinated Band Pullapart; 15 reps
Renegade Row; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12-15 min):
Close Grip Lat Pulldown or Neutral Grip Pull Up
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 @ 20X1 - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Drop back to your Set 1 weight/assistance and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1 (Aim for 8+ reps)

Loading Note:

If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match the band or machine assistance to the prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For Set 4, drop back to your set 1 weight or assistance and perform as many reps as possible, aiming for 8 or more reps. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):
Supinated Barbell Bent Over Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Barbell Upright Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Kelso Shrug; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):
2-3 sets
Cable Forearm Curls or DB Wrist Curl; 12-15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Cross Body Hammer Curl; 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 30-60 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Bottom of Bench Dip Stretch; 30 sec

Sidelying Thoracic Rotation w/ Reach; 5/side
Tall Kneeling Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April 2nd, 2026

Week 2 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work :

A) Active Recovery (40 min)
Bike or Row 20mins @ Easy Pace
At minutes 4, 8, 12, 16, and 20, get off the bike or rower and complete the following:
10 controlled 90/90 Hip Rolls (5/side)
10 Alternating Squat with Reach (hold 2sec/side)
25' Duck Walk
Bike or Row 20mins @ Easy Pace
At minutes 4, 8, 12, 16, and 20, get off the bike or rower and complete the following:
8 Perfect Stretch Walk (4/side)
25' Ostrich Walk
*Move continuously at a steady pace for 40 minutes. Never exceed a pace that allows you to hold a comfortable conversation. You should not be breathing so heavily that you can't speak in complete sentences.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Overhead
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5/side with 2-3 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Swimmer x 5 with 5 sec hold in overhead position.

Friday, April 3rd, 2026

Week 2 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Romanian Deadlift Technique
When performing Romanian deadlifts, aim to achieve the greatest hamstring stretch you can without compromising your low back position. Keep the low back consistent and close to neutral throughout the hinge. Allow a slight bend in the knees, but avoid letting them bend further as you

lower. The goal is to hinge at the hips, not squat the weight down. You also don't need to touch the floor — stop where you can maintain tension and position.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Front Foot Elevated Hand Support KOT Suitcase Split Squat; 10 reps/side
Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Front Rack Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Hand Supported Ipsilateral Suitcase Step Down; 6-8 reps/side @30X0
rest 60 sec
Tuck L Sit on Parallettes; 20-30 sec
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

:
2-3 sets
Knees Over Toes Double Leg Calf Raise; 10-15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
3 Way Seated Hip Abduction; 5-8 reps in each position.
rest 30-60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note;
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, April 4th, 2026

Week 2 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Arnold Press
The Arnold press appears each week in the second Strength Intensity section, but your body position will change slightly from week to week to create a different stimulus. These adjustments alter the demand on shoulder mobility and core involvement. Pay attention to which variations feel strongest and which feel most challenging — that feedback can help you understand your current movement limitations and strengths.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Diamond Plank; 30 sec
Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position
Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Low Incline Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):
Single Arm Arnold Z Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
Body Row; 10-15 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Single Arm DB or Cable Lean Away Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warm-up set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 Min):
2-3 sets
Cross Body Kettlebell Carry; 20m/side
rest 15 sec
Ring or Plank Body Saw; 30 sec
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be challenging and fatiguing for the upper body.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Sunday, April 5th, 2026

Week 2 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

If you complete 100% of your workouts feeling comfortable, something's off.
Intensity doesn't mean chaos or wrecking yourself day after day. But it does mean getting close to the edge of your current capacity. That edge is where adaptation happens.

I call it sustainable intensity. It means honoring the tempo, pushing to the prescribed RPE, getting full range of motion, and adding a little load when it's time. In other words, stick to the program and make sure you read all the training notes.

This week, choose one movement and truly push it where it's meant to be pushed. You might surprise yourself.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday, March 30th, 2026

Week 2 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
March 30th, 2026

A) Daily Focus Note:
Single Leg DB RDL Technique
During the single-leg DB RDL, let your back foot point toward the ground rather than opening out to the side. This helps your pelvis rotate toward the front leg and allows for a smoother, more natural hinge at the hip. You can reinforce this by gently turning your “zipper line” slightly toward the stance leg as you lower the weight. Both cues improve hip mechanics and help you feel the work where we want it most — the glutes of the working leg rather than the low back. Focus on control and balance first, then load.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets

Split Squat Isometric; 20-30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 minutes):
Cyclist Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets; rest 60sec between sides
Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 8 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for an RPE of 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remaining two sets.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Leg Behind Plate Loaded Pistol; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Plate Loaded Banded Spanish Squat; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
DB Side Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 30 sec
Weighted Anchored Sit Up; 10-15 reps
rest 60 sec and back to 1.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets

Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, March 31st, 2026

Week 2 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
March 31st, 2026

A) Daily Focus Note:
Dips + Deficit Pushups
Dips and deficit pushups give you one of the biggest opportunities to explore shoulder mobility in horizontal pressing. Both movements place the shoulder into deeper extension and rotation than most presses. At the bottom of each rep, move into as much stretch as you can comfortably control. Stay active in that position — don't relax into it. Maintaining tension in the stretched range creates a strong muscle-building stimulus while also improving usable flexibility. Controlled depth over rushed reps.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Banded Shoulder External Rotation; 10-15 reps/side
PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Push Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @30X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):
Supinated Barbell Bent Over Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Deficit Pushup; 8-10 @ 31X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 8-10 @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):
2-3 sets
Cable Forearm Curls or DB Wrist Curl; 12-15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Cross Body Hammer Curl; 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 30-60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Bottom of Bench Dip Stretch; 30 sec
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation w/ Reach; 5/side
Tall Kneeling Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday, April 1st, 2026

Week 2 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
April 1st, 2026

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (5-10min):
Overhead
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5/side with 2-3 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min

Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Swimmer x 5 with 5 sec hold in overhead position.

Thursday, April 2nd, 2026

Week 2 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
April 2nd, 2026

A) Daily Focus Note:
Romanian Deadlift Technique
When performing Romanian deadlifts, aim to achieve the greatest hamstring stretch you can without compromising your low back position. Keep the low back consistent and close to neutral throughout the hinge. Allow a slight bend in the knees, but avoid letting them bend further as you lower. The goal is to hinge at the hips, not squat the weight down. You also don't need to touch the floor — stop where you can maintain tension and position.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Front Foot Elevated Hand Support KOT Suitcase Split Squat; 10 reps/side
Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Front Rack Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 Min):
3 sets
Hand Supported Ipsilateral Suitcase Step Down; 6-8 reps/side @30X0
rest 60 sec
Tuck L Sit on Parallettes; 20-30 sec
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Knees Over Toes Double Leg Calf Raise; 10-15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
3 Way Seated Hip Abduction; 5-8 reps in each position.
rest 30-60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note;
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday, April 3rd, 2026

Week 2 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
April 3rd, 2026

A) Daily Focus Note:
Pulldown/Pull Up Descending Rep Scheme
The descending rep scheme (12, 10, 8), paired with increasing RPE, is designed to let you add load to each set. This is straightforward with the pulldown—simply increase the weight as the reps decrease. Pull Ups can be a bit different. Because they're highly fatiguing, you may keep the same level of assistance across all sets and still reach the target RPE. Each set builds fatigue in the back and lats, making the next set feel significantly harder even without changing the assistance. Focus on matching the effort, not forcing the progression.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Diamond Plank; 30 sec
Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position
Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Close Grip Lat Pulldown or Neutral Grip Pull Up
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Drop back to your Set 1 weight/assistance and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1 (Aim for 8+ reps)
Loading Note:
If using Pull Ups instead of pulldowns, match the band or machine assistance to the prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For Set 4, drop back to your set 1 weight or assistance and perform as many reps as possible, aiming for 8 or more reps. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Low Incline Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Barbell Upright Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Kelso Shrug; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):
2-3 sets
Hollow Body DB Floor Press; 10-12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 15 sec
Band or Cable Chest Fly; 12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, April 4th, 2026

Week 2 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
April 4th, 2026

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run, Row or Bike
3mins @ 70%
2min @ 80%
1min @ 90%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 15sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
Even - 15sec Side Plank/side
Run, Row or Bike
3mins @ 70%
2min @ 80%
1min @ 90%

EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 15sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
Even - 15sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run, Row or Bike
3mins @ 70%
2min @ 80%
1min @ 90%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 with 3 sec hold
Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10
Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5

Sunday, April 5th, 2026

Week 2 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

If you complete 100% of your workouts feeling comfortable, something's off.
Intensity doesn't mean chaos or wrecking yourself day after day. But it does mean getting close to the edge of your current capacity. That edge is where adaptation happens.

I call it sustainable intensity. It means honoring the tempo, pushing to the prescribed RPE, getting full range of motion, and adding a little load when it's time. In other words, stick to the program and make sure you read all the training notes.

This week, choose one movement and truly push it where it's meant to be pushed. You might surprise yourself.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday, March, 30th, 2026

Week 2 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Front Squat Progression
This training cycle alternates between two front squat variations: the traditional front squat and the cyclist front squat. Each one serves a different purpose, so you can make steady progress across all 6 weeks. The traditional front squat is your strength-focused day. Expect heavier and more challenging sets where the priority is maintaining strong positioning and producing quality tension under load. The cyclist front squat shifts the emphasis toward the legs. With the elevated heels and more upright torso, you'll be able to accumulate more quad-focused volume without needing maximal weight. By rotating these variations week to week, you'll build strength and muscle while making progress without excessive fatigue or joint stress throughout the cycle.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Split Squat Isometric; 20-30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 minutes):
Cyclist Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Close Grip Lat Pulldown or Neutral Grip Pull up
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 @ 20X1 - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Drop back to your Set 1 weight/assistance and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1 (Aim for 8+ reps)
Loading Note:
If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match the band or machine assistance to the prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For Set 4, drop back to your set 1 weight or assistance and perform as many reps as possible, aiming for 8 or more reps. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Deficit Pushup; 8-10 @ 31X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 8-10 @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
DB Side Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 30 sec
Weighted Anchored Sit Up; 10-15 reps
rest 60 sec and back to 1.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 6-8 reps/side
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, March, 31st, 2026

Week 2 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-12 min):
Hip Mobility
Shinbox Switch x 6-8
Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox IR Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Switch x3-5/side
Low Switch Cossack x8-10/side
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Squat Hold x 1-2 min
Slow Bodyweight Squat x 5

Wednesday, April, 1st, 2026

Week 2 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Barbell Row
Each week for the first three weeks of this progression, the hand position changes to target a slightly different area of the back. Because of these small differences, the weights will likely vary from week to week. Don't worry about increasing load from the previous week — instead, note the weight you used for this specific variation and aim to improve it the next time it appears in the cycle.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Banded Shoulder External Rotation; 10-15 reps/side
PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Push Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @30X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):
Supinated Barbell Bent Over Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 Min):
Week 2
3 sets
Hand Supported Ipsilateral Suitcase Step Down; 6-8 reps/side @30X0
rest 60 sec
Tuck L Sit on Parallettes; 20-30 sec
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):
Week 2
2-3 sets
Cable Forearm Curls or DB Wrist Curl; 12-15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Cross Body Hammer Curl; 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo
rest 30-60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.
Cooldown (5 min):
Week 2
1-2 sets
Bottom of Bench Dip Stretch; 30 sec
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation w/ Reach; 5/side
Tall Kneeling Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April, 2nd, 2026

Week 2 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (12-15 min):
Upper Body Mobility
Shoulder Circles
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side
Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side
Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side
Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side
Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Downdog to Updog x 5

Friday, April, 3rd, 2026

Week 2 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Romanian Deadlift Technique
When performing Romanian deadlifts, aim to achieve the greatest hamstring stretch you can without compromising your low back position. Keep the low back consistent and close to neutral throughout the hinge. Allow a slight bend in the knees, but avoid letting them bend further as you lower. The goal is to hinge at the hips, not squat the weight down. You also don't need to touch the floor — stop where you can maintain tension and position.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Front Foot Elevated Hand Support KOT Suitcase Split Squat; 10 reps/side
Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Romanian Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Low Incline Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Leg Behind Plate Loaded Pistol; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Plate Loaded Banded Spanish Squat; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
Week 2
2-3 sets
Cross Body Kettlebell Carry; 20m/side
rest 15 sec
Ring or Plank Body Saw; 30 sec
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be challenging and fatiguing for the upper body.
Cooldown (5 min)
Week 2

1-2 sets
Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, April, 4th, 2026

Week 2 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run, Row, or Bike
3mins @ 70%
2min @ 80%
1min @ 90%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 15sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
Even - 15sec Side Plank/side
Run, Row, or Bike
3mins @ 70%
2min @ 80%
1min @ 90%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 15sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
Even - 15sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run, Row, or Bike
3mins @ 70%
2min @ 80%
1min @ 90%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 with 3 sec hold
Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side

Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10
Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5

Sunday, April 5th, 2026

Week 2 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

If you complete 100% of your workouts feeling comfortable, something's off.
Intensity doesn't mean chaos or wrecking yourself day after day. But it does mean getting close to the edge of your current capacity. That edge is where adaptation happens.

I call it sustainable intensity. It means honoring the tempo, pushing to the prescribed RPE, getting full range of motion, and adding a little load when it's time. In other words, stick to the program and make sure you read all the training notes.

This week, choose one movement and truly push it where it's meant to be pushed. You might surprise yourself.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday, March 30th, 2026

Week 2 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x
PUMP CONDITION 5x - April

A) Daily Focus Note:
Spanish Squat
The Spanish squat is a specialized exercise, often using a heavy resistance band behind the knees, that allows for heavy quad loading while minimizing knee cap compression. Its often used in rehabiliation settings, and is great for strengthening the quadriceps, improving knee stability, and reducing knee pain by keeping shins more vertical.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+

2-3 Sets
Split Squat Isometric; 20-30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):
Cyclist Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Leg Behind Plate Loaded Pistol; 6-8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Plate Loaded Banded Spanish Squat; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge + Core Intervals (15 min):
Every 60 sec x 15 sets
1st - 8-12 Strict Toes to Bar or Hanging Knee Tucks
2nd - 40sec Dual KB Clean from Floor 53/35# (Male/Female)
3rd - Bike 40sec @ High Effort
Effort Note:
You will perform only one exercise per minute.
At the start of each 60-second interval, complete the assigned movement for that minute. When the minute ends, rest for the remainder of the time. At the top of the next minute, move to the next exercise in the sequence.
The order rotates as follows:
Minute 1 – 1st exercise only
Minute 2 – 2nd exercise only
Minute 3 – 3rd exercise only
Then repeat that rotation for all 15 sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, March 31st, 2026

Week 2 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:
DB Bench Press Progression
This training block uses three different dumbbell bench press variations, each providing a slightly different stimulus. The traditional DB bench press serves as the baseline. The alternating DB bench press increases time under tension since one arm stabilizes while the other performs the rep. The low incline DB bench press adds a longer range of motion and challenges the pecs from a slightly different angle. Each variation brings its own benefit, and rotating through all three helps develop a more balanced and resilient shoulder complex for horizontal pressing.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Banded Shoulder External Rotation; 10-15 reps/side
PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Push Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Deficit Pushup; 8-10 @ 31X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec
Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 8-10 @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Couplets (15 min):
2 Sets
For Time
500/400m Row (Male/Female)
-60sec rest-
3 rounds for time:
16 Alternating DB Bench Press 50/35# (8 reps/side)
40 Double Unders or 60 Single Unders
-90-second rest and then repeat from the beginning for a second set-
Effort Note:
For each set (there are 2), complete the 500m Row, take a 60-second rest, then complete 3 rounds of the couplet. Upon completion of your 3rd round of the couplet, rest 90 seconds and then go back to the Row for the second set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Wednesday, April 1st, 2026

Week 2 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Pulldown/Pull Up Descending Rep Scheme
The descending rep scheme (12, 10, 8), paired with increasing RPE, is designed to let you add load to each set. This is straightforward with the pulldown—simply increase the weight as the reps decrease. Pull Ups can be a bit different. Because they're highly fatiguing, you may keep the same level of assistance across all sets and still reach the target RPE. Each set builds fatigue in the back and lats, making the next set feel significantly harder even without changing the assistance. Focus on matching the effort, not forcing the progression.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
:
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Supinated Band Pullapart; 15 reps
Renegade Row; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Close Grip Lat Pulldown or Neutral Grip Pull Up
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Drop back to your Set 1 weight/assistance and perform a Max UB reps @20X1 (Aim for 8+ reps)
Loading Note:
If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For Set 4, drop back to your set 1 weight or assistance and perform as many reps as possible, aiming for 8 or more reps.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 Min):
3 sets
DB Upright Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Supinated Barbell Bent Over Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) High Turnover Cardio (12 min):
12 mins Continuous Effort
2-4-6-8-10-12...
KB Gorilla Row 70/53 (R+L = 1) (Male/Female)

KB Goblet Carry 30m, 70/53
*6/5 Calorie Bike Between Sets
Effort Note:
Ascend as far as you can in the KB Row, performing the Carry and Bike between each set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Bottom of Bench Dip Stretch; 30 sec
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation w/ Reach; 5/side
Tall Kneeling Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April 2nd, 2026

Week 2 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Active Recovery Work :

A) Active Recovery (40 min)
Bike or Row 20mins @ Easy Pace
At minutes 4, 8, 12, 16, and 20, get off the bike or rower and complete the following:
10 controlled 90/90 Hip Rolls (5/side)
10 Alternating Squat with Reach (hold 2sec/side)
25' Duck Walk
Bike or Row 20mins @ Easy Pace
At minutes 4, 8, 12, 16, and 20, get off the bike or rower and complete the following:
8 Perfect Stretch Walk (4/side)
25' Ostrich Walk
*Move continuously at a steady pace for 40 minutes. Never exceed a pace that allows you to hold a comfortable conversation. You should not be breathing so heavily that you can't speak in complete sentences.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Overhead
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5/side with 2-3 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Swimmer x 5 with 5 sec hold in overhead position.

Friday, April 3rd, 2026

Week 2 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Romanian Deadlift Technique
When performing Romanian deadlifts, aim to achieve the greatest hamstring stretch you can without compromising your low back position. Keep the low back consistent and close to neutral throughout the hinge. Allow a slight bend in the knees, but avoid letting them bend further as you lower. The goal is to hinge at the hips, not squat the weight down. You also don't need to touch the floor — stop where you can maintain tension and position.
Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Front Foot Elevated Hand Support Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 10 reps/side
Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Hand Supported Ipsilateral Suitcase Step Down; 6-8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Tuck L Sit on Parallettes; 20-30 sec
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Interval Lower Body Weight Training (12-15 min):

3 Sets
Run 200m
rest 15sec
12 Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand 53/35# (Male/Female)
12 Goblet Squat 53/35#
rest 15sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3 - Tough Pace

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, April 4th, 2026

Week 2 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Lean Away Lateral Raise
The lean-away dumbbell lateral raise increases the range of motion and changes the resistance curve to better isolate the side deltoid. By leaning away from a support, you create a greater stretch at the bottom and more tension at the top of the movement. This helps improve muscle engagement and supports broader shoulder development. Stay smooth and controlled to keep the focus on the delt rather than momentum.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Diamond Plank; 30 sec
Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position
Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Low Incline Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Body Row; 10-15 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Single Arm DB or Cable Lean Away Lateral Raise;; 12-15 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Vertical Push/Pull Conditioning (12 min):
Every 2mins x 6 sets
8-10 Burpees
4-8 Supinated Strict Pull Up @ 20X0 Tempo
8-10 Alternating KB Push Press 35/26# @ 20X0 (Male/Female)
Effort Note:
*Every 2 minutes, you begin a new set
*Pull Ups - Scale your pull ups down or up with bands or an added dumbbell between your legs to challenge yourself each round in the 4-8 rep range.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Sunday, April 5th, 2026

Week 2 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

If you complete 100% of your workouts feeling comfortable, something's off.
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I call it sustainable intensity. It means honoring the tempo, pushing to the prescribed RPE, getting full range of motion, and adding a little load when it's time. In other words, stick to the program and make sure you read all the training notes.

This week, choose one movement and truly push it where it's meant to be pushed. You might surprise yourself.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday, March 30th, 2026

Week 2 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Spanish Squat
The Spanish squat is a specialized exercise, often using a heavy resistance band behind the knees, that allows for heavy quad loading while minimizing knee cap compression. Its often used in rehabiliation settings, and is great for strengthening the quadriceps, improving knee stability, and reducing knee pain by keeping shins more vertical.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Split Squat Isometric; 20-30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):
Cyclist Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps ` Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Leg Behind Plate Loaded Pistol; 6-8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Plate Loaded Banded Spanish Squat; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge + Core Intervals (15 min):
Every 60 sec x 15 sets
1st - 8-12 Strict Toes to Bar or Hanging Knee Tucks
2nd - 40sec Dual KB Clean from Floor 53/35# (Male/Female)
3rd - Bike 40sec @ High Effort
Effort Note:
You will perform only one exercise per minute.
At the start of each 60-second interval, complete the assigned movement for that minute. When the minute ends, rest for the remainder of the time. At the top of the next minute, move to the next exercise in the sequence.
The order rotates as follows:
Minute 1 – 1st exercise only
Minute 2 – 2nd exercise only
Minute 3 – 3rd exercise only
Then repeat that rotation for all 15 sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
Week 2 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x
March 31st, 2026

Tuesday, March 31st, 2026

Week 2 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x
A) Daily Focus Note:
Pulldown/Pull Up Descending Rep Scheme
The descending rep scheme (12, 10, 8), paired with increasing RPE, is designed to let you add load to each set. This is straightforward with the pulldown—simply increase the weight as the reps decrease. Pull Ups can be a bit different. Because they're highly fatiguing, you may keep the same level of assistance across all sets and still reach the target RPE. Each set builds fatigue in the back and lats, making the next set feel significantly harder even without changing the assistance. Focus on matching the effort, not forcing the progression.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Banded Shoulder External Rotation; 10-15 reps/side
PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Close Grip Lat Pulldown or Neutral Grip Pull Up
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Drop back to your Set 1 weight/assistance and perform a Max UB reps @20X1 (Aim for 8+ reps)
Loading Note:
If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For Set 4, drop back to your set 1 weight or assistance and perform as many reps as possible, aiming for 8 or more reps.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
DB Upright Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Supinated Barbell Bent Over Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Couplets (14 min):
Every 2 minutes x 3 Sets
12/10 Cal Row @ High Effort (Male/Female)
12 Deficit Pushup @30X0
Rest 2:00 minutes
Every 2 minutes x 3 Sets
12/10 Cal Row @ High Effort
30m Farmers Walk 70/53#
Effort Note:
Every 2 minutes, you begin a new set. Take 2 minutes' rest after your first three sets. Push the pace on these intervals.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
Cat Cow; 6-8 reps
Week 2 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x
April 1st, 2026

Wednesday, April 1st, 2026

Week 2 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x
A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (5-10 min):
Overhead
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5/side with 2-3 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Swimmer x 5 with 5 sec hold in overhead position.
Week 2 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x
April 2nd, 2026

Thursday, April 2nd, 2026

Week 2 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x
A) Daily Focus Note:
Romanian Deadlift Technique
When performing Romanian deadlifts, aim to achieve the greatest hamstring stretch you can without compromising your low back position. Keep the low back consistent and close to neutral throughout the hinge. Allow a slight bend in the knees, but avoid letting them bend further as you lower. The goal is to hinge at the hips, not squat the weight down. You also don't need to touch the floor — stop where you can maintain tension and position.
Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Front Foot Elevated Hand Support Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 10 reps/side
Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Hand Supported Ipsilateral Suitcase Step Down; 6-8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Tuck L Sit on Parallettes; 20-30 sec
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Interval Lower Body Weight Training (12-15 min):
3 Sets

Run 200m
rest 15sec
12 Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand 53/35# (Male/Female)
12 Goblet Squat 53/35#
rest 15sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3 - Tough Pace

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side
Week 2 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x
April 3rd, 2026

Friday, April 3rd, 2026

Week 2 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x
A) Daily Focus Note:
Lean Away Lateral Raise
The lean-away dumbbell lateral raise increases the range of motion and changes the resistance curve to better isolate the side deltoid. By leaning away from a support, you create a greater stretch at the bottom and more tension at the top of the movement. This helps improve muscle engagement and supports broader shoulder development. Stay smooth and controlled to keep the focus on the delt rather than momentum.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Diamond Plank; 30 sec
Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position
Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Low Incline Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Body Row; 10-15 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Single Arm DB or Cable Lean Away Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Vertical Push/Pull Conditioning (12 min):
Every 2mins x 6 sets
8-10 Burpees
4-8 Supinated Strict Pull Up @ 20X0 Tempo
8-10 Alternating KB Push Press 35/26# @ 20X0 (Male/Female)
Effort Note:
*Every 2 minutes, you begin a new set
*Pull-Ups - Scale your pull-ups down or up with bands or an added dumbbell between your legs to challenge yourself each round in the 4-8 rep range.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec
Week 2 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x
April 4th, 2026

Saturday, April 4th, 2026

Week 2 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x
A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run, Row, or Bike
3mins @ 70%
2min @ 80%
1min @ 90%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 15sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
Even - 15sec Side Plank/side
Run, Row, or Bike
3mins @ 70%
2min @ 80%
1min @ 90%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 15sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
Even - 15sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run, Row, or Bike
3mins @ 70%
2min @ 80%
1min @ 90%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 with 3 sec hold
Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10
Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5

Sunday, April 5th, 2026

Week 2 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

If you complete 100% of your workouts feeling comfortable, something's off.
Intensity doesn't mean chaos or wrecking yourself day after day. But it does mean getting close to the edge of your current capacity. That edge is where adaptation happens.

I call it sustainable intensity. It means honoring the tempo, pushing to the prescribed RPE, getting full range of motion, and adding a little load when it's time. In other words, stick to the program and make sure you read all the training notes.

This week, choose one movement and truly push it where it's meant to be pushed. You might surprise yourself.

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday, March 30th, 2026

Week 2 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Deficit Pushup
If you're completing the deficit pushups comfortably within the prescribed rep range, here are a few ways to increase the challenge without adding weight: Slow the lowering phase even more. Add a pause at the top or bottom of each rep. Focus on increasing muscle tension throughout the movement—actively squeeze the pecs at the top and maintain tension through the pecs and triceps as you lower. Small adjustments in control can dramatically increase the stimulus.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Split Squat Isometric; 20-30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):
Cyclist Front Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Deficit Pushup; 8-10 reps @ 31X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 8-10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Hinge + Core Intervals (15 min):
Every 60 sec x 15 sets
1st - 8-12 Strict Toes to Bar or Hanging Knee Tucks
2nd - 40sec Dual KB Clean from Floor 53/35# (Male/Female)
3rd - Bike 40sec @ High Effort
Effort Note:
You will perform only one exercise per minute.
At the start of each 60-second interval, complete the assigned movement for that minute. When the minute ends, rest for the remainder of the time. At the top of the next minute, move to the next exercise in the sequence.
The order rotates as follows:
Minute 1 – 1st exercise only
Minute 2 – 2nd exercise only
Minute 3 – 3rd exercise only
Then repeat that rotation for all 15 sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 6-8 reps/side
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, March 31st, 2026

Week 2 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min) :
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip Mobility
Shinbox Switch x 6-8
Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox IR Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Switch x3-5/side
Low Switch Cossack x8-10/side
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Squat Hold x 1-2 min
Slow Bodyweight Squat x 5

Wednesday, April 1st, 2026

Week 2 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Push Press Technique
The push press is an explosive overhead lift that allows for an over-loaded weight by nature of using the legs to assist the press during the hardest portion. Make sure to control the lockout and descent to get the most out of this lift.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
Banded Shoulder External Rotation; 10-15 reps/side
PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Push Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @30X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
DB Upright Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Supinated Barbell Bent Over Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Interval Lower Body Weight Training (12-15 min):
3 Sets
Run 200m
rest 15sec
12 Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand 53/35# (Male/Female)
12 Goblet Squat 53/35#
rest 15sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3 - Tough Pace

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Bottom of Bench Dip Stretch; 30 sec
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation w/ Reach; 5/side
Tall Kneeling Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April 2nd, 2026

Week 2 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (12-15):
Upper Body Mobility
Shoulder Circles
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side
Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side
Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side
Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side
Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec Hold
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Downdog to Updog x 5

Friday, April 3rd, 2026

Week 2 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Note:
Romanian Deadlift Technique
When performing Romanian deadlifts, aim to achieve the greatest hamstring stretch you can without compromising your low back position. Keep the low back consistent and close to neutral throughout the hinge. Allow a slight bend in the knees, but avoid letting them bend further as you lower. The goal is to hinge at the hips, not squat the weight down. You also don't need to touch the floor — stop where you can maintain tension and position.
Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Front Foot Elevated Hand Support Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 10 reps/side
Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Romanian Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Body Row; 10-15 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
Single Arm DB or Cable Lean Away Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Couplets (14 min):
Every 2 minutes x 3 Sets
12/10 Cal Row @ High Effort (Male/Female)
12 Deficit Pushup @30X0
Rest 2:00 minutes
Every 2 minutes x 3 Sets
12/10 Cal Row @ High Effort
30m Farmers Walk 70/53#
Effort Note:
Every 2 minutes, you begin a new set. Take 2 minutes' rest after your first three sets. Push the pace on these intervals.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, April 4th, 2026

Week 2 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30-35 min) :

Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run, Row, or Bike
3mins @ 70%
2min @ 80%
1min @ 90%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 15sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
Even - 15sec Side Plank/side
Run, Row, or Bike
3mins @ 70%
2min @ 80%
1min @ 90%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 15sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
Even - 15sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run, Row, or Bike
3mins @ 70%
2min @ 80%
1min @ 90%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 Min):
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 with 3 sec hold
Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10
Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5

Sunday, April 5th, 2026

Week 2 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

If you complete 100% of your workouts feeling comfortable, something's off.
Intensity doesn't mean chaos or wrecking yourself day after day. But it does mean getting close to the edge of your current capacity. That edge is where adaptation happens.

I call it sustainable intensity. It means honoring the tempo, pushing to the prescribed RPE, getting full range of motion, and adding a little load when it's time. In other words, stick to the program and make sure you read all the training notes.

This week, choose one movement and truly push it where it's meant to be pushed. You might surprise yourself.

With love,
Marcus

Perform

Monday, March 30th, 2026

Week 2 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:
Power Clean and Box Jumps
Olympic lifts are one of the best tools for improving your jump because they train the body to produce maximum power, force, and speed in a very short window — exactly what an explosive jump demands.
In today's training, the power clean is paired with jumping for a reason. The clean potentiates your nervous system, making you feel more springy and reactive when you go to jump. Take advantage of that and commit to jumping as high as possible on every single rep.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
1) Split Squat Isometric; 20-30 sec/side
2) Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15min):
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Romanian Deadlift
10 Strict Press

10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold
10 sec Front Squat Hold
+
4-5 sets; rest 90-120sec between sets
2 Power Clean + 4 Box Jump Step Down
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging
*Aim for max power on the jump every rep, even if the box height is easily attainable.

D) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):
Cyclist Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Leg Behind Plate Loaded Pistol; 6-8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. Plate Loaded Banded Spanish Squat; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Interval Weight Training (15 min):
3 Sets x 3 min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP)
650/520m Bike (Male/Female)
12 Alternating Suitcase Low Box Step Up 53/35# or 35/26# 20/16" (6/leg)
6 Right Arm Single Arm KB Thruster 53/35# or 35/26#
6 Left Arm Single Arm KB Thruster 53/35# or 35/26#
- in remaining time:

KB Russian Twists
- rest 2mins between sets

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2) Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
3) Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, March 31st, 2026

Week 2 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:
Hot Start
The first part of training is where your mental focus tends to be sharpest, which is why Persist often opens with conditioning. Starting with the Hot Start lets you channel that energy into learning better pacing strategies — how to manage effort, stay controlled, and find the right intensity for you.
At the same time, the conditioning work primes your body for the strength training that follows. Think of it as turning everything on so you're physically and mentally ready to get the most out of the rest of the session.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
1) Banded Shoulder External Rotation; 10-15 reps/side
2) PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Engine Hot Start (10 min):
Every 2:30 x 3-4 Sets at Increasing Pace
30sec HS Hold
Bike 600/480m (Male/Female)
rest remaining time
Effort Note
Set 1 - Easy to Moderate
Set 2 - Moderate
Set 3 - Moderate to Hard

Set 4 - Hard

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Push Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @30X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Deficit Pushup; 8-10 @ 31X1 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 8-10 @ 30X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Upper Couplets (15 min):
2 Sets
For Time
500/400m Row (Male/Female)
-60sec rest-
3 rounds for time:
16 Alternating DB Bench Press 50/35# (8/side)
40 Double Unders or 60 Single Unders
-90-second rest and then repeat from the beginning for a second set-
Effort Note:
For each set (there are 2), complete the 500m Row, take a 60-second rest, then complete 3 rounds of the couplet. Upon completion of your 3rd round of the couplet, rest 90 seconds and then go back to the Row for the second set.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
2) Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side

3) Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Wednesday, April 1st, 2026

Week 2 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:
Pulldown/Pull Up Descending Rep Scheme
The descending rep scheme (12, 10, 8), paired with increasing RPE, is designed to let you add load to each set. This is straightforward with the pulldown—simply increase the weight as the reps decrease. Pull ups can be a bit different. Because they're highly fatiguing, you may keep the same level of assistance across all sets and still reach the target RPE. Each set builds fatigue in the back and lats, making the next set feel significantly harder even without changing the assistance. Focus on matching the effort, not forcing the progression.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
1) 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2) Supinated Band Pullapart; 15 reps
3) Renegade Row; 6-8 reps/side

C) Kettlebell Hot Start (10 min):
4 Rounds Increasing Effort:
15/12 Calorie Bike (Male/Female)
16 Alternating KB Clean from Floor 53/35# (8/arm)
16 KB Sumo Deadlift High Pull 53/35#
rest 45 sec between rounds
Round 1 - Moderate
Round 2 - Hard
Round 3-4 - Very Tough Pace

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Close Grip Lat Pulldown or Neutral Grip Pull Up
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Drop back to your Set 1 weight/assistance and perform a Max UB reps @20X1 (Aim for 8+ reps)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. Each set should decrease in assistance or increase in additional weight. For Set 4, drop back to your set 1 weight or assistance and perform as many reps as possible, aiming for 8 or more reps.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. DB Upright Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
2. Supinated Barbell Bent Over Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
- rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Aerobic Carry (16 min):
16min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP) @ 75-80% Effort
40/32 Calorie Bike (Male/Female)
24 Feet Anchored Sit Up
12 DB Burpee
100 Feet Farmers Carry 70/53# or 53/35#

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Bottom of Bench Dip Stretch; 30 sec
2) Sidelying Thoracic Rotation w/ Reach; 5/side
3) Tall Kneeling Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, April 2nd, 2026

Week 2 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Bike or Row 20mins @ Easy Pace
At minutes 4, 8, 12, 16, and 20 get off the rower and complete the following:
10 controlled 90/90 Hip Rolls (5/side)

10 Alternating Squat with Reach (hold 2sec/side)
25' Duck Walk
Bike or Row 20mins @ Easy Pace
At minutes 4, 8, 12, 16, and 20 get off the bike and complete the following:
8 Perfect Stretch Walk (4/side)
25' Ostrich Walk
*Move continuously at a steady pace for 40 minutes. Never exceed a pace that allows you to hold a comfortable conversation. You should not be breathing so heavily that you can't speak in complete sentences.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Overhead
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5/side with 2-3 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Swimmer x 5 with 5 sec hold in overhead position.

Friday, April 3rd, 2026

Week 2 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:
Romanian Deadlift Technique
When performing Romanian deadlifts, aim to achieve the greatest hamstring stretch you can without compromising your low back position. Keep the low back consistent and close to neutral throughout the hinge. Allow a slight bend in the knees, but avoid letting them bend further as you lower. The goal is to hinge at the hips, not squat the weight down. You also don't need to touch the floor — stop where you can maintain tension and position.
Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1) 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2) Front Foot Elevated Hand Support Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 10 reps/side
3) Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift

10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
+
Every 2:00 x 5 sets
2 Full Snatch + 1 Snatch Grip BTN Push Press + 1 Overhead Squat
- rest until the next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Hand Supported Ipsilateral Suitcase Step Down; 6-8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. Tuck L Sit on Parallettes; 20-30 sec
- rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Threshold Lower Body (15 min):
3-4 Sets
Row 200m
4 DB Burpee Box Step Over 45/30# (24/20" box) (Male/Female)
6 DB Front Squat 45/30#
12 Feet Anchored Sit Ups

6 DB Front Squat 45/30#
4 DB Burpee Box Step Over 45/30l# 24/20"
Row 200m
rest 2mins

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
2) Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
3) Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, April 4th, 2026

Week 2 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Note:
Gymnastics Skill Training
Skill training can be frustrating at times, and that's actually what makes it so valuable. The challenge of learning something new or refining how your body moves goes well beyond building muscle — it's one of the most powerful ways to improve brain health and function.
Be intentional with the gymnastics section today. Approach each rep as a chance to improve your execution, not just complete the movement. Focus on quality, stay patient with the process, and trust that the effort you put into skill work pays off in ways that go far beyond the gym.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
1) Diamond Plank; 30 sec
2) Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position
3) Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps

C) Gymnastics Skills (8 min):
4 sets each; rest as needed
1. 2-3 Strict Ring Muscle Up
2. 30sec Hollow Rock or Bent Hollow Rock
Effort Note:
Any muscle up variation is acceptable in place of the strict ring muscle up. A regression may be the following:

Strict Ring Muscle Up > Muscle Up > Bar Muscle Up > Band Assisted Muscle Up > Muscle Up Ring Row + Ring Dip

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Low Incline Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Body Row; 10-15 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
2. Single Arm DB or Cable Lean Away Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Vertical Push/Pull Conditioning (12 min):
Every 2mins x 6 sets
8-10 Burpees
4-8 Supinated Strict Pull Up @ 20X0 Tempo
8-10 Alternating KB Push Press 35/26# @ 20X0 (Male/Female)
Effort Note:
*Every 2 minutes, you begin a new set
*Pull Ups - Scale your pull ups down or up with bands or an added dumbbell between your legs to challenge yourself each round in the 4-8 rep range.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
Week 2
1-2 sets
1) Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
2) Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3) Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Sunday, April 5th, 2026

Week 2 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM

If you complete 100% of your workouts feeling comfortable, something's off.
Intensity doesn't mean chaos or wrecking yourself day after day. But it does mean getting close to the edge of your current capacity. That edge is where adaptation happens.

I call it sustainable intensity. It means honoring the tempo, pushing to the prescribed RPE, getting full range of motion, and adding a little load when it's time. In other words, stick to the program and make sure you read all the training notes.

This week, choose one movement and truly push it where it's meant to be pushed. You might surprise yourself.

With love,
Marcus

Minimalist

Monday, March 30th, 2026

Week 2 Day 1 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Note:
Cyclist Squat
The heel elevation needed in the cyclist squat can come from a variety of sources. You can use specialized squat wedges/blocks, weightlifting shoes with built-in heel lifts, small weight plates (like 2.5 or 5 lb), or a 2x4 piece of wood. All of these implements can work. Use whatever you have available to you, and keep it consistent for the entire training block.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
1) Split Squat Isometric; 20-30 sec/side
2) Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 minutes):
DB Suitcase Cyclist Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Leg Behind Goblet Pistol; 6-8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
2. Wall Sit; 40-60 sec
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge + Core Intervals (15 min):
Every 60 sec x 15 sets
1st - 8-12 Strict Toes to Bar or Hanging Knee Tucks
2nd - 40sec Dual DB Clean from Floor 50/35# (Male/Female)
3rd - Jump Rope or Jumping Jacks 40sec @ High Effort
Effort Note:
You will perform only one exercise per minute.
At the start of each 60-second interval, complete the assigned movement for that minute. When the minute ends, rest for the remainder of the time. At the top of the next minute, move to the next exercise in the sequence.
The order rotates as follows:
Minute 1 – 1st exercise only
Minute 2 – 2nd exercise only
Minute 3 – 3rd exercise only
Then repeat that rotation for all 15 sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec

2) Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
3) Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, March 31st, 2026

Week 2 Day 2 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Note:
DB Push Press Purpose
The push press is used to build maximum upper-body power, explosiveness, and total-body strength by using the legs to lift heavier weights overhead than a strict press allows. It enhances athletic hip drive, and allows for an overload on the shoulders during the lowering portion.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
1) Banded Shoulder External Rotation; 10-15 reps/side
2) PVC Alternating Shoulder Circles; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Push Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 30X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @30X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. DB Upright Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Bent Over Row; 10-12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo
- rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Couplets (12 min):
Every 3 minutes x 4 Sets
12 Deficit Pushup @30X0
12 Burpees
30m Farmers Walk 70/50# (Male/Female)
Effort Note:
Every 3 minutes, you begin a new set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
2) Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
3) Cat Cow; 6-8 reps

Wednesday, April 1st, 2026

Week 2 Day 3 - Persist Minimalist

A) Active Recovery Work: Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Overhead
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5/side with 2-3 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Swimmer x 5 with 5 sec hold in overhead position.

Thursday, April 2nd, 2026

Week 2 Day 4 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Note:
Romanian Deadlift Technique
When performing Romanian deadlifts, aim to achieve the greatest hamstring stretch you can without compromising your low back position. Keep the low back consistent and close to neutral throughout the hinge. Allow a slight bend in the knees, but avoid letting them bend further as you lower. The goal is to hinge at the hips, not squat the weight down. You also don't need to touch the floor — stop where you can maintain tension and position.

Short on Time? Remove Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1) 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2) Front Foot Elevated Hand Support Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 10 reps/side
3) Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Hand Supported Ipsilateral Suitcase Step Down; 6-8 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. Tuck L Sit on Parallettes; 20-30 sec
- rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Interval Lower Body Weight Training (12-15 min):
3 Sets
Run 200m
rest 15sec
12 Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand 53/35# (Male/Female)
12 Goblet Squat 50/35#
rest 15sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace

Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3 - Tough Pace

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Couch Stretch Rocks; 30 sec/side
2) Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side
3) Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday, April 3rd, 2026

Week 2 Day 5 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Note:
Lean Away Lateral Raise
The lean-away dumbbell lateral raise increases the range of motion and changes the resistance curve to better isolate the side deltoid. By leaning away from a support, you create a greater stretch at the bottom and more tension at the top of the movement. This helps improve muscle engagement and supports broader shoulder development. Stay smooth and controlled to keep the focus on the delt rather than momentum.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
2-3 Sets
1) Diamond Plank; 30 sec
2) Banded YTW; 6-8 reps in each position
3) Forearm Plank to Dolphin Pose; 5-7 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Single Arm DB Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6/side@20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Single Arm DB Meadow Row; 8-10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
2. DB Lean Away Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps/side @ 30X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Vertical Push/Pull Conditioning (12 min):
Every 2mins x 6 sets
8-10 Burpees
4-8 Supinated Strict Pullup @ 20X0 Tempo
8-10 Alternating DB Push Press 35/25# @ 20X0 (Male/Female)
Effort Note:
*Every 2 minutes, you begin a new set
*Pull-Ups - Scale your pull-ups down or up with bands or an added dumbbell between your legs to challenge yourself each round in the 4-8 rep range.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Banded Single Arm Cross Body Stretch; 30 sec/side
2) Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3) Hands Clasped Behind Back Shoulder Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, April 4th, 2026

Week 2 Day 6 - Persist Minimalist

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work:
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run, Row or Bike
3mins @ 70%
2min @ 80%
1min @ 90%
EMOM x 6mins

Odd - 15sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
Even - 15sec Side Plank/side
Run, Row or Bike
3mins @ 70%
2min @ 80%
1min @ 90%
EMOM x 6mins
Odd - 15sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
Even - 15sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run, Row or Bike
3mins @ 70%
2min @ 80%
1min @ 90%

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Shoulder Flexion
1. Passive Hang x 1 min
2. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10/side with 5 sec hold
3. PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
4. Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 with 3 sec hold
5. Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10
7. Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5

Sunday, April 5th, 2026

Week 2 Day 7 - Persist Minimalist

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This week, choose one movement and truly push it where it's meant to be pushed. You might surprise yourself.

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Marcus